

■ PAID FEATURE · CHAT

Chat: one secure inbox for students, mentors, and staff.

A communication layer for 1:1 and group messaging across students, ambassadors, coordinators, and university staff, keeping support conversations inside the Intoto ecosystem.

PRIMARY USERS

Students · Staff · Ambassadors · Coordinators

ADMIN OWNER

University Super Admin / support team

COMMERCIAL MODEL

Standalone paid module

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■ FEATURE OVERVIEW

Support conversations without personal phone numbers.

Chat gives universities controlled messaging across their Intoto community. Students can contact the right person, staff can create groups, and conversations stay attached to university roles instead of scattered across personal apps.

What the client gets

When Active, Chat unlocks mobile Chats tab, web Chat sidebar, direct messaging, group creation, inboxes, message threads, read/unread states, and contextual sharing where other modules allow it. When inactive, chat surfaces are hidden.

1:1

Direct support conversations

Group

Staff-created or role-based group messaging

Live

Conversation history in one product

Safe

No need for personal contact sharing

■ WHAT USERS CAN DO

Chat supports the conversations around every other feature.

INBOX

View conversations

Users open a Chats tab or sidebar to see conversations, unread badges, participants, and recent messages.

MESSAGE

Send direct messages

Students, staff, ambassadors, and coordinators can send role-appropriate messages where permissions allow.

GROUPS

Create group conversations

CONTEXT

Share module content

Web users can create groups for cohorts, events, support teams, ambassador groups, or operational follow-up.

Community posts, events, or support context can be shared into conversations where those modules allow sharing.

SUPPORT

Centralize help

Students get one place for support, academic questions, buddy conversations, financial aid, or group updates.

CONTROL

Entitlement-based access

If Chat is not Active, messaging routes and tabs are hidden even if another feature references people or profiles.

Supported message and share types

TYPE	WHAT USERS CAN SEND	CLIENT VALUE
Text	Plain typed messages for questions, support replies, instructions, and follow-up notes.	Fast everyday communication without email threads.
Audio	Voice notes or audio clips where enabled for quick explanations and language-friendly support.	Helpful when typing is slow or a student needs a more personal answer.
Video	Video file messages or video attachments where enabled by the app configuration.	Useful for orientation guidance, issue explanation, or richer peer support.
Images - single	One image, screenshot, campus photo, document photo, or proof image in a message.	Students can show exactly what they need help with.
Images - multiple	Multiple images in one message, such as several document pages or event photos.	Keeps related visual evidence together in the same conversation.

TYPE	WHAT USERS CAN SEND	CLIENT VALUE
Documents	Files such as PDF, DOC, or other supported attachments for forms, letters, confirmations, or instructions.	Staff and students can exchange formal material without leaving Intoto.
Shared events	An Event Management event card shared into a direct or group chat.	Recipients can understand the event context without copying long event details manually.
Shared community posts	A Community post shared into a conversation, preserving the original post context.	Useful posts can move from a group discussion into targeted follow-up.
Shared communities	A community profile or community reference shared into chat where the app supports it.	Students can be guided to the right group instead of searching manually.
Profile or user context	User/profile links or context from people surfaces, subject to privacy and role permissions.	Staff can connect the right student, ambassador, or coordinator to the right conversation.

How Chat works with other paid features

COMMUNITY

Post-to-chat follow-up

A useful or sensitive community post can be shared into chat so a coordinator, student, or support team can continue the discussion privately.

EVENTS

Event card sharing

Event details can be shared into a cohort or support group so recipients see the event name, timing, and context without retyping the information.

AMBASSADORS

MOBILITY

Mentor conversations

When Ambassador Management and Chat are both Active, students can move from an ambassador profile to a direct support conversation.

Application support

Mobility staff can use chat-style support to follow up on missing information, document questions, or pre-departure guidance where the product route allows it.

■ ANIMATED EXPLANATION

How a conversation starts and stays inside Intoto.

PLAY STORY

● USER

● ADMIN

● UNIVERSITY

● DECISION

CURRENT ACTOR

Student or staff user

A user-facing action in the product experience.

USER ACTION · 1 OF 7

Write message

User starts a message from inbox, profile, or shared context.

Outcome: Message draft is sent into the correct conversation thread.

INFORMATION TAKEN

Selected contact or group, sender identity, recipient role, message text, attachment/share context where available.

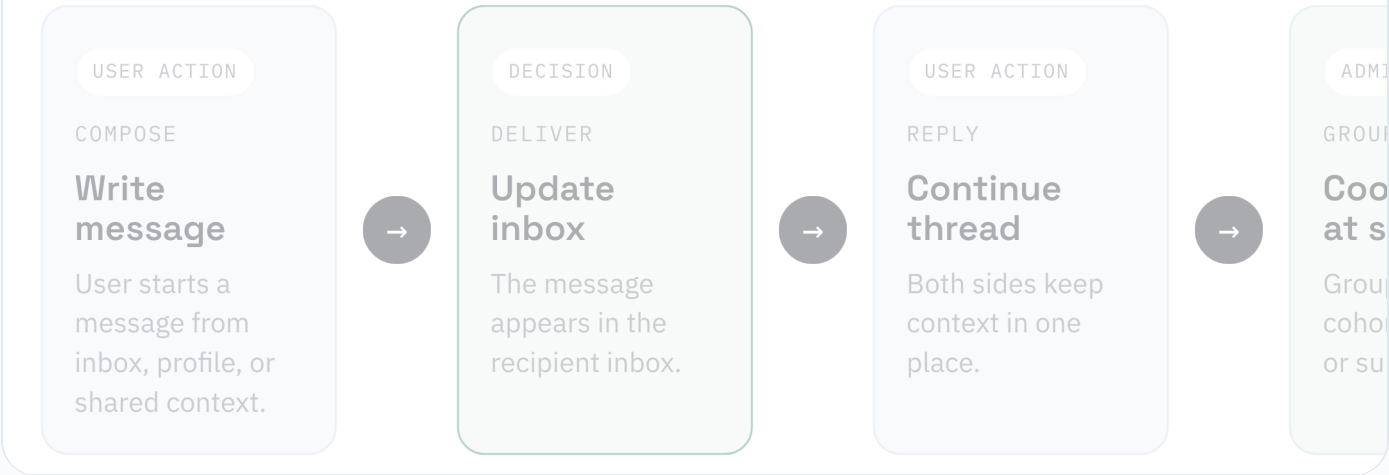
HOW IT IS REVIEWED

App checks Chat entitlement and whether the sender can message the target.

DECISION / RESULT

Message draft is sent into the correct conversation thread.

Direct and group chat flow



■ FAQs

Chat questions clients usually ask.

What can users send in Chat?	+
Can users send documents in Chat?	+
Can users send one image or multiple images?	+
Can Chat support audio messages?	+
Can Chat support video messages?	+
Can events be shared in Chat?	+

Can Community posts be shared in Chat?

+

Can a community itself be shared in Chat?

+

Is Chat required for Community or Ambassador conversations?

+

Can staff create group conversations?

+

Can students message ambassadors?

+

Does Chat replace email?

+

How does Chat help university staff?

+

What controls who can message whom?

+

What happens when Chat is inactive?

+